

Laptop Ledger — Sourced Data Report

Four laptops, five comparison criteria. Each value below is the exact figure used in the comparison tool, with its source and any conflicting figures found during research.

1. MacBook Air 13" (M3, 2024)

Config used: 8GB RAM / 256GB SSD, 8-core CPU / 8-core GPU

Criterion	Value used	Source	URL
Price	\$1,099	Laptop Mag	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/macbooks/macbook-air-13-inch-m3
Battery	18 hrs (Apple-rated, Apple TV app video playback)	Apple Support — Tech Specs	https://support.apple.com/en-us/118551
Weight	2.7 lb (1.24 kg)	EveryMac.com	https://everymac.com/systems/apple/macbook-air/specs/macbook-air-m3-8-core-cpu-8-core-gpu-13-2024-specs.html
Performance	9/10 (analyst-interpreted)	Laptop Mag review verdict	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/macbooks/macbook-air-13-inch-m3
RAM / Storage	8GB / 256GB	Laptop Mag, confirmed by Apple Support	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/macbooks/macbook-air-13-inch-m3 ; https://support.apple.com/en-us/118551

Conflict — Price: AppleInsider's price tracker lists the 13" line starting at **\$999** (<https://prices.appleinsider.com/product/macbook-air-13-inch-m3/MXCV3LL/A>), while Laptop Mag and Tom's Guide both independently report **\$1,099** as the base MSRP. *Resolution:* \$999 reflects a discounted/CTO configurator price, not Apple's standard list price. Two independent review outlets agree on \$1,099 as the official starting price, so that figure was used.

Conflict — Battery: Laptop Mag reports "over 15 hours" in real-world testing, while Apple's own spec sheet claims up to 18 hours (video playback) / 15 hours (wireless web). *Resolution:* Used Apple's official 18-hour figure (video playback) for consistency with how other

vendors' battery claims are sourced (manufacturer-rated), and noted in the tool that lab-tested, real-world numbers typically run lower.

2. Dell XPS 13 (9350, 2024, Intel Core Ultra 7 258V)

Config used: 16GB RAM / 512GB SSD

Criterion	Value used	Source	URL
Price	\$1,399	Laptop Mag	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/windows-laptops/dell-xps-13-9350
Battery	~24 hrs (video playback, lab-tested)	TechRadar	https://www.techradar.com/computing/windows-laptops/dell-xps-13-intel-core-ultra-2nd-gen-2025-review
Weight	2.6 lb	Laptop Mag	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/windows-laptops/dell-xps-13-9350
Performance	7/10 (analyst-interpreted)	TechRadar review verdict	https://www.techradar.com/computing/windows-laptops/dell-xps-13-intel-core-ultra-2nd-gen-2025-review
RAM / Storage	16GB / 512GB	Laptop Mag	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/windows-laptops/dell-xps-13-9350

Conflict — Which XPS 13 model: Three different "Dell XPS 13" variants surfaced in research: the Snapdragon X Elite 9345 (Live Science reports 27h39m battery), the Intel Lunar Lake 9350 (TechRadar reports ~24h), and the older 2024 Snapdragon 9340 (Tom's Guide, starting \$1,299). *Resolution:* Standardized on the **9350 (Intel Core Ultra 7 258V, Lunar Lake)** throughout, since it's Dell's current mainstream 2024 configuration and the one Laptop Mag priced and speced in detail. Figures from the Snapdragon variants were excluded to avoid mixing specs across different chip platforms.

Conflict — Battery test method: Notebookcheck/Tom's Hardware (per aggregator frontdeskreview.com) measured 17.5–20+ hours on the LCD panel using their own lab protocol, versus TechRadar's ~24 hours on video playback. *Resolution:* Used TechRadar's figure as the primary source since it's a first-party, directly-read review; the lower Notebookcheck/Tom's Hardware range is noted in the tool as a methodology caveat (different test = different result, not a factual contradiction).

3. Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Carbon (Gen 12, 2024)

Config used: Intel Core Ultra 5, 16GB RAM / 256GB SSD (base configuration)

Criterion	Value used	Source	URL
Price	\$1,499	StorageReview.com	https://www.storagereview.com/review/lenovo-thinkpad-x1-carbon-gen-12-review
Battery	14h 40m (PCMark10 "Modern Office" test, 50% brightness)	StorageReview.com	https://www.storagereview.com/review/lenovo-thinkpad-x1-carbon-gen-12-review
Weight	2.42 lb	PCWorld	https://www.pcworld.com/article/2250722/lenovo-thinkpad-x1-carbon-review.html
Performance	7/10 (analyst-interpreted)	PCWorld review verdict	https://www.pcworld.com/article/2250722/lenovo-thinkpad-x1-carbon-review.html
RAM / Storage	16GB / 256GB	StorageReview.com	https://www.storagereview.com/review/lenovo-thinkpad-x1-carbon-gen-12-review

Conflict — Price: Reported prices for the X1 Carbon Gen 12 ranged wildly: StorageReview's base config starts at **\$1,499**; Tom's Hardware's tested unit (16GB/512GB, no OLED) starts at **\$2,263**; Laptop Mag's OLED review unit was **\$2,199**; Notebookcheck reported a discounted sale price of **\$1,099** (down from a \$2,099 list). *Resolution:* Used StorageReview's **\$1,499** base-config price as the representative figure, since a budget-conscious student is most likely to buy the entry trim rather than the OLED/high-RAM review units other outlets tested. The tool's research panel flags that the OLED version this laptop is best known for costs significantly more.

Conflict — Battery life: StorageReview measured 14h40m (PCMark10), while ITPro's Core Ultra 5 test unit measured only **10h29m**, and Tom's Hardware called battery life "subpar" without giving a precise figure (OLED panel). *Resolution:* Used StorageReview's 14h40m as it's the most precisely documented, methodology-labeled figure. The wide spread (10h29m-14h40m depending on panel type and workload) is noted as a real methodology/config difference, not an error — OLED and IPS panel variants of this laptop have meaningfully different battery life.

4. ASUS Zenbook 14 OLED (Q425M / UX3405, 2024)

Config used: Intel Core Ultra 7 155H, 16GB RAM / 1TB SSD

Criterion	Value used	Source	URL
Price	\$1,049.99	Laptop Mag	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/windows-laptops/asus-zenbook-14-oled-2024-review
Battery	14h 30m (video-looping test)	Digital Trends	https://www.digitaltrends.com/computing/asus-zenbook-14-oled-2024-review/
Weight	2.65 lb	MMORPG.com	https://www.mmorpg.com/hardware-reviews/asus-zenbook-14-oled-2024-review-2000130443
Performance	8/10 (analyst-interpreted)	Laptop Mag review verdict ("nearly perfect," "snappy performance")	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/windows-laptops/asus-zenbook-14-oled-2024-review
RAM / Storage	16GB / 1TB	Laptop Mag	https://www.laptopmag.com/laptops/windows-laptops/asus-zenbook-14-oled-2024-review

Conflict — Which configuration/price: Digital Trends reviewed a higher-spec unit (32GB RAM/1TB, Core Ultra 7 155H) at **\$1,300**, while Laptop Mag's Q425 model (16GB/1TB, same CPU) lists at **\$1,049.99**, and MMORPG.com separately cites **\$1,299** for a 2.65 lb unit. *Resolution:* Used Laptop Mag's Q425 configuration and price (\$1,049.99) as the primary record since it's the best-documented, lowest-cost trim with the same CPU — appropriate for a budget student use case. Higher-RAM configs from other reviewers were excluded to keep the RAM/storage figure consistent with the priced trim.

Conflict — Battery life: Digital Trends' own testing showed a nearly 2x spread depending on workload: **~7 hours** on a continuous web-browsing test vs. **~14h 30m** on a video-looping test. Separately, Tom's Hardware (via frontdeskreview.com aggregation) measured **12h 21m** on a streaming/web/OpenGL mixed test. *Resolution:* Used the 14h30m video-looping figure as the representative "everyday use" number (most comparable to how other laptops' battery figures were sourced), while flagging in the tool that workload type drastically changes this laptop's real-world battery life — this is a genuine methodology-dependent result, not a data error.

Notes on the Performance criterion generally

No single benchmark (e.g., Geekbench) was available across all four laptops from directly-read sources, and the four machines span three chip architectures (Apple Silicon, Intel Core Ultra, Qualcomm Snapdragon variants in related models). Rather than mixing incompatible benchmark numbers, Performance scores (1-10) were derived by the analyst from each outlet's own verdict language and are explicitly flagged in the comparison tool as **interpreted, not raw sourced data**.

Notes on Storage/RAM value

This criterion is a calculated metric — $(\text{RAM in GB} + \text{Storage in GB} \div 10) \div \text{price}$ — built from the sourced RAM, storage, and price figures above. It is not itself a number published by any reviewer.